

GRILLED EGGPLANT, TOMATO & MINT SALAD

INGREDIENTS

2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil, plus more for drizzling

1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice

2 garlic cloves, grated

½ teaspoon za'atar

½ teaspoon sea salt, plus more for sprinkling

Freshly ground black pepper

1 medium eggplant, 1 pound, cut into ½-inch-thick rounds

1 red bell pepper, stemmed, seeded, and quartered lengthwise

1 cup cherry tomatoes, halved

½ cup crumbled feta cheese

⅓ cup red onions

⅓ cup basil leaves

⅓ cup mint leaves

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: In a large bowl, whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, garlic, za'atar, salt, and pepper. Heat a grill or grill pan to medium-high heat.

Step 2: Place the eggplant and red pepper pieces on a large plate or in a large baking dish and drizzle with olive oil and sprinkle with salt and pepper. Toss to coat.

Step 3: Place the eggplant and pepper on the hot grill and cook for 2 to 5 minutes per side, or until well charred and tender. Remove from the grill and chop into 1-inch pieces.

Step 4: Add the grilled veggies to the bowl with the dressing and stir to coat. Let sit for 5 minutes, then fold in the tomatoes, feta, red onions, and half the basil and mint. Season to taste, garnish with the remaining basil and mint, and serve.

THE COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef

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